Figure 8.2. Evidence-to-Practice Pathway: Stress Physiology: HPA Axis, Autonomic Regulation, and Allostasis

1 Define the question and context

Specify the exposure, population, timing, and decision. Distinguish the question from the explanation.

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2 Specify the process and evidence

Identify the relevant biological level and the method used to study it. Separate observation from inference.

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3 Assess outcomes and alternatives

Consider symptoms, function, safety, context, and competing explanations. Group findings do not determine an individual diagnosis.

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4 Select a proportionate action

Relate evidence to assessment, education, supervised practice, or research. Record limits and responsibilities.

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5 Monitor and review

Review outcomes, uncertainty, adverse effects, and new information. Revise the interpretation when warranted.

Arrows show an educational decision sequence, not biological causation or a validated clinical algorithm. Apply this framework to the chapter topics; it does not prescribe treatment or establish diagnostic accuracy.

Source: Chapter 8, section outline and existing discussion of evidence, interpretation, application, and review. Original editorial schematic; no empirical data are plotted. Subject-author review remains required.